98% energy import dependency?

The Pre-Budget Document's energy figure, tested against Eurostat

THE CLAIM

"…Malta's energy import dependency is approximately 98.0 per cent, the highest in the European Union."

Ministry for Finance, Pre-Budget Consultation Document 2027, 30 September 2026

Document launched for the 2027 Budget consultation.

Import dependency = net imports / gross available energy.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

Level and ranking reproduce; the year is not stated.

SUPPORTED | **LARGELY SUPPORTED** | NOT SUBSTANTIATED | MISLEADING | CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

98.4%

Malta, 2024

Eurostat's latest value; 97.0–99.0% in every year 2019–2024.

1st

Highest of 27

Next in 2024: Luxembourg 91.0%, Cyprus 87.7%. Malta first every year 2016–2024.

57.3%

EU-27 average, 2024

Malta's ratio is about 41 points above the EU average.

68.5%

Shipping fuel

International maritime bunkers are 68.5% of the energy counted for Malta in 2024.

?

No year given

No year gives exactly 98.0; the document does not say which it used.

FAIR TO SAY

Accurate as a statement about Eurostat's indicator. It does not show how much household or business energy is imported.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ Ministry: state the reference year.
- ☐ Readers: bunkers dominate the ratio.
- ☐ See CC-095 on energy subsidies.
- ☐ Data: Eurostat nrg_ind_id.